J.W. Couch Education: Get Outside Grant

Due September 26, 2025

Priority Area (Wellness: Get Outside): *Being outside can improve memory, fight depression, lower blood pressure, and more! We support organizations that facilitate and encourage more outdoor activities that help create healthier communities.*

J.W. Couch Foundation Grant Application

1. **Contact Information**
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2. **Organization Information**
    - **Organization Name:** Hanna Education Center dba Hanna Academy
    - **Organization Website URL:** www.hannaacademy.org
    - **Organization Focus (Preservation / Education / Wellness):** Wellness
    - **Tax ID:** 88-2156897
    - **Year Founded:** 2023
    - **Mission Statement:** Hanna Academy educates, prepares, and empowers students to succeed in school and life by developing their unique and individual talents and gifts. The student-driven program develops academic, social, and career skills within a safe, inclusive, and nurturing environment.
3. **Project Information**
    - **Project Name:** After School Wellness for High-Needs Youth
    - **Project Summary:** Hanna Academy empowers students through Honor, Academics, Wellness, Kindness, and Success (HAWKS). Students come to Hanna Academy for its focus on specialized education and support for behavioral and emotional challenges. One hundred percent of Hanna Academy students have Individualized Education Plans (IEPs) and have not typically found success in traditional school environments. Many of Hanna's youth have faced trauma, instability, and limited access to healthy extracurricular opportunities. Without sports, music, or clubs on campus, students often struggle with motivation, structure, and connection. To address this, Hanna is launching the After School Wellness Program, designed to take learning and growth beyond the classroom and into the world. For youth who have been excluded from extracurricular and peer socialization activities by both challenge and choice, the new program provides both opportunity and incentive for students to work toward positive behavior and outcomes.

The program will provide regularly scheduled outdoor activities focused on cultural and education exploration, social and community connection, and wellness and recreation—such as kayaking, hiking, biking, ropes courses, surfing, outdoor cooking, museums, and sporting events—that connect academic lessons with real-world experiences. These activities are not only recreational, but also therapeutic, offering students a way to manage stress, build resilience, and develop teamwork skills and put their classroom learning into a real-world context. Each trip emphasizes social-emotional learning, leadership, and the HAWKS values, while giving students something positive to work toward.

By "getting outside," Hanna students will:

- Improve physical and mental wellness
- Strengthen peer and staff relationships
- Gain confidence through new challenges
- Build a sense of belonging and purpose

The Wellness Program is more than an incentive system—it is a lifeline for students who need structured, positive outlets to thrive. With J.W. Couch Foundation's partnership, Hanna can transform wellness from a concept into a lived practice, creating lasting impacts in the lives of Hanna's youth, one outdoor experience at a time.

- **Project Objectives:** The Wellness Program aims to:
  1. Promote Outdoor Wellness: Increase student access to nature-based activities such as hiking, biking, kayaking, and surfing to reduce stress and support physical and emotional health.
  2. Strengthen School Engagement: Use field trips as an incentive structure that improves classroom behavior, attendance, and participation.
  3. Foster Positive Relationships: Provide shared experiences that help students build trust and respect with peers and staff, reducing isolation and conflict.
  4. Develop Leadership & Accountability: Engage students in goal-setting, self-monitoring, and reflection to cultivate responsibility, confidence, and the HAWKS values.
  5. Expand Horizons: Expose students to new environments, career pathways, and community connections, broadening their vision for the future.
- **Grant Plans:** Funding from the J.W. Couch Foundation will directly support the After School Wellness Program including trip costs, transportation, admission fees, activity equipment, and staff supervision. Specifically, this budget will allow Hanna Academy to host 20 wellness-focused field trips during the 2025-2026 academic year open to all 52 Hanna Academy students encouraging cultural and educational exploration, social and community connection, and wellness and recreation.

  Grant dollars will ensure that all activities are safe, accessible, and inclusive—covering essentials such as fees, materials costs, transportation costs as well as staff salaries and benefits. Hanna Academy staff

will track student participation, behavior scores, and post-trip reflections to measure progress in wellness, classroom engagement, and social skills.

Beyond the funding year, Hanna Academy plans to integrate the Wellness Field Trip Program into its broader wellness and behavioral supports. By demonstrating improved student outcomes, Hanna will seek additional local and regional partners to sustain and grow the program, ultimately embedding "get outside" experiences into the fabric of our educational model.

4. **More Details** Hanna Academy and its students are excited about the opportunity get outside and engage with their community in new and experiential ways. They hope support from the J.W. Couch Foundation will support this important work connecting high-needs and at-risk youth to these positive, foundational and formative experiences.
5. **Financial Information**
    - **Funding Amount Requested (Minimum request of $50,000 required) :** $50,000
    - **Budget Timetable:** Academic Year 2025-2026
    - **Annual Operational Budgets (upload) –** WILL UPLOAD WITH SUBMISSION
    - **Relevant Grant Request Budgets (upload) –** WILL UPLOAD WITH SUBMISSION
6. **Supporting Documents**
    - **IRS Determination Letter (upload) –** WILL UPLOAD WITH SUBMISSION
    - **Most Recent IRS 990/EZ/PF Filings (upload) –** WILL UPLOAD WITH SUBMISSION
    - **Other Attachments (optional; accepted file types pdf, docx, xlsx, jpg, gif, png)**
7. **Miscellaneous**
    - **How Did You Learn About Us?** (options: Online Search, **Instrumentl**, GetEdFunding, Grant Gopher, Social Media, Referral, Other)